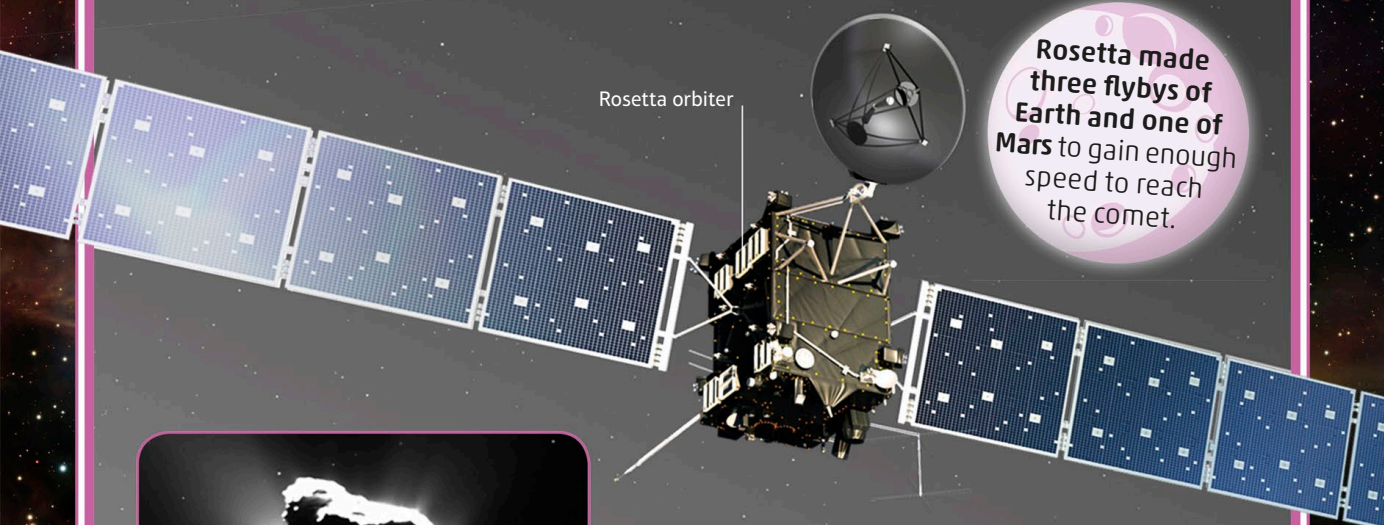
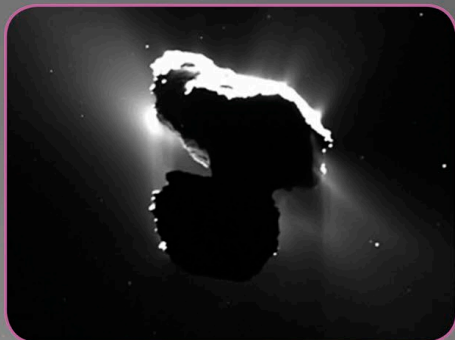


ROSETTA AND PHILAE

Orbiter and lander



Rosetta made three flybys of Earth and one of Mars to gain enough speed to reach the comet.



Comet 67P as seen by Rosetta

The European Space Agency's Rosetta mission was the first in history to meet up with a comet – Comet 67P – and to follow it as it orbited the Sun. On 12 November 2014, the lander Philae detached from Rosetta and became the first man-made object to land on a comet's surface when it touched down on 67P.

DATA FILE



SIZE: Rosetta – 2.8 m (9 ft) wide (without solar panels); Philae – 1 m (3.3 ft) wide



DATE OF LAUNCH: 2 March 2004



MISSION DURATION: 12 years, 6 months



SPACE AGENCY: ESA